

Start-ups Will Fuel India's Growth

India's burgeoning start-up ecosystem is driving transformative growth, setting the stage for a dynamic future



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INDIA'S JOURNEY SINCE Independence is nothing short of extraordinary. In just 76 years, our young nation has transformed itself with remarkable socio-economic progress. Poverty has declined dramatically, literacy rates have soared, and life expectancy continues to rise. The vision of becoming a developed nation, or Viksit Bharat, by 2047 is not just an aspiration but a collective mission. The groundwork is laid. Now, it's time to accelerate this momentum.

India's digital revolution is in full swing. Initiatives like the JAM trinity (Jan-Dhan Yojana, Aadhaar, and Mobile Telephony) and the success of the Unified Payments Interface (UPI) are laying the foundation for a robust digital economy. Complementing these are large-scale infrastructure projects like BharatNet, Sagarmala, and Bharatmala, which are enhancing connectivity and logistics, making India a fertile ground for economic growth.

India's start-up ecosystem is the engine that will drive this socio-economic transformation. With over 117,000 recognised start-ups, includ-

ing 110 unicorns, India is already the world's third-largest start-up hub. These start-ups are not just confined to metros; they are emerging in Tier II and III cities, creating over 1.24 million jobs in 2023 alone. What is fuelling this is a young, tech-savvy population of nearly 800 million internet users.

Start-ups are also catalysing socio-economic transformation. India's entrepreneurial prowess, once confined to IT and e-commerce, now spans finance, healthcare, education, agriculture, and space. As the world considers a 'China+1' strategy to diversify supply chains, India's strategic position is proving to be key in making it a global manufacturing leader.

Here are eight key areas that, with concerted efforts, could turn from moonshots to sure-things.

● MOONSHOT 1

Becoming Talent Surplus:

To harness the full potential of our young population, we must invest in STEM education and grassroots entrepreneurship. Start-ups are uniquely positioned to harness this potential and fuel innovation and growth.

● MOONSHOT 2

Focussing on AI and Deep-

tech: AI and deeptech are pivotal to India's innovation surge.